



The First 72 Hours

A survival plan for the first three days of no contact

digitaldisconnect.shop/guides/first-72-hours-of-no-contact

The first three days of no contact are usually the most intense. Habit, hope and panic all peak at once. The good news is that you only have to get through them once, and every hour you manage makes the next one a little easier.

Before you start (30 minutes)

- Mute or archive their chat, and mute their social accounts
- Tell one friend you're starting no contact and ask them to check in
- Choose where your phone will charge at night (not your bedroom)
- Write down your reasons for doing this, and keep them on your phone

Day 1: Just today

Don't think about 30 days. Think about today. Eat something, drink water, get outside for ten minutes, and write down what happened in plain words. Expect waves of wanting to reach out. When one hits, wait 20 minutes and write instead.

Day 2: The phone problem

Day two is often when the "just one message" logic kicks in. Notice when you reach for your phone and what you felt right before. Make contact harder: move apps, rename their contact to "Wait 20 minutes", hand your phone to a friend during your riskiest hour.

Day 3: Body first

By day three, exhaustion often sets in. Prioritise sleep, a real meal, and movement. A short walk does more than it seems. Write down one thing that felt slightly better than day one, even if it's tiny.

Nights are the danger zone

1. Phone out of the bedroom an hour before sleep
2. Ten minutes of writing to empty your head
3. A plan for waking at 3am: get up, dim light, read or write, no phone
4. A friend you can text instead, if you need to talk

What to expect

Crying, trouble sleeping, no appetite, replaying conversations and sudden panic are all common in the first days. They usually ease. If you feel unsafe, or it doesn't ease, reach out to a doctor or a crisis line. In the US, call or text 988.

What I'm taking from this guide

NEXT STEP

Put it into practice for 30 days.

The No-Contact Journal is a printable 30-day guided journal: 90 prompts, a daily no-contact check-in, and a "Before you text them" page for the moments you're about to reach out.

Get it at digitaldisconnect.shop

Or start free with the 3-day starter at digitaldisconnect.shop/free

This guide is general self-help information, not therapy, medical or legal advice. If you're thinking about harming yourself, in the US call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or contact your local emergency number.

© The No-Contact Journal · Free to share in full with credit.